sign the eviction papers of illegal immigrants. Somiah's direction made the gravity of the situation clear. He said:

State governments should evolve a system of supporting posts to the Border Security Forces to work as a second line of interception. These posts could be located in the rear areas at suitable checkpoints like railway stations and sensitive roads leading to the border. It is necessary to intensify riverine patrolling in Sunderbans area to block the influx of illegal immigrants as well as illicit movement of arms from Bangladesh. It is necessary to have timely exchange of information between the BSF and other central agencies and the state agencies regarding the happenings on the border. Events in Bangladesh and the influx of minority groups from there may create communal tension in India. There may be some agents behind the influx of Bangladesh nationals to India. It may be useful to collect intelligence about such agents with a view to keep watch over their activities. The police communication network in the border areas needs to be improved on a priority basis. All the border police stations should be provided with wireless network immediately. For push back operations, the infiltrators will have to be collected from areas of their illegal stay and taken to the border in batches. It may be necessary to keep them in transit camps for some time as pushing back operations can only be carried out in small groups.

The MHA was also worried about the BSF's strength at the border: was the force large enough to deal with a massive influx of illegal immigrants? In 1975, the border vigil force had deployed eighteen battalions with three placed in reserve. Though the ministry had decided to deploy the reserve battalions on the border as well, it understood that these